

Cypress - Installation & Setup

A complete guide to prepare the environment, install, configure, validate and perform the first functional use of the tool.

Manual objective

This manual guides you through the complete installation and setup process, from preparing the environment to final validation. Follow the steps in order and use the checks throughout the guide to confirm that each configuration was completed correctly.

Official references

<https://www.cypress.io/>

<https://docs.cypress.io/>

<https://docs.cypress.io/app/get-started/install-cypress>

Prerequisites

Install a Node.js and package-manager version supported by your Cypress release and verify node/npm versions.

Step-by-step installation

Run `npm install cypress --save-dev`, then `npx cypress open`. The Launchpad configures E2E or Component Testing.

Initial configuration

Review `cypress.config`, `baseUrl`, `retries`, `viewport`, `timeouts` and `reporters`. Keep secrets in environment variables.

First test

Create a spec, use `cy.visit`, resilient selectors and assertions. Use `cypress open` while developing and `cypress run` in automation.

Selectors and commands

Prefer `data-*` attributes intended for testing when appropriate. Encapsulate reusable actions in custom commands without hiding important test rules.

Troubleshooting

Check Node version, binary download, proxies, permissions, cache and Linux dependencies.

How to start safely

Start from the official Cypress site and documentation. Confirm prerequisites, supported versions, operating system and required permissions. Learn in a controlled environment before using it in a critical workflow.

First QA-oriented use

Pick one small, verifiable task in Cypress, configure only what is necessary, run a simple example and confirm the outcome. Repeat with different data or conditions before adding abstractions.

Common issues and troubleshooting

When Cypress fails, verify versions, dependencies, permissions, connectivity, data and environment before assuming a product defect. Preserve the original error and reduce the issue to the smallest reproducible case.